

STRENGTH IN SWEAT A poster of *Working Girls*

collar working women such as erotic dancers, ASHA workers, egg donors, care workers, farm labourers, grassroots organisers and union leaders. Vohra's thesis—what you imagine when you think of a working girl and what their life could possibly be like—is an invitation to consider modes of feminist livelihood and resistance outside mass-mediated tropes of caste-Hindu, white-collar female workers.

Touchingly enough, most of these interviewees have seen the film. Vohra feels fortunate to have seen "the shades of emotion ripple over their faces... women whose work is made invisible have drawn on a certain self-possession to withstand the world's humiliations and uncaringness... I think they took the respect of the film with that same self-possession but also *sukoon* at having been seen."

Among the film's highlights is Vohra's mishmash of funky animation, tongue-in-cheek voiceover and clever use of music. In all her docus, Vohra has steadfastly refused the "narrowness of linear character-driven narratives" that have "colonised our non-fiction forms, making for dispassionate films".

Vohra's oeuvre includes non-fiction on Bollywood, screenwriting the acclaimed 2003 film *Khamosh Pani*, her platform Agents of Ishq that celebrates positive depictions of sex in media and culture, and goofy appearances in Channel [V] India ads in the '90s.

Noting that her varied work is "mostly motivated by curiosity and delight", she adds feeling "a deep impatience for flat-footed understandings of people and reality, devoid of contradiction and self-doubt that pass for politics and art in our times". Here's hoping this agent of *ishq* stays forever unlimited. ■

—Devarsi Ghosh

THE AIR

Jazz-lovers are in for a treat as the Bengaluru Jazz Fest, supported by Bosch, is all set to enthral them over the course of three music-filled weekends across the city. Featuring an eclectic line-up of jazz stalwarts, including Gerard Machado and Radha Thomas; Carnatic greats such as Sukanya Ramgopal and Karthik Mani; and international artistes like Magnus Dauner and Peter Natterer, and the Bosch Big Band, the programme promises an unforgettable celebration of sound and soul. "The idea has been on the horizon for a long time," says Jagadeesh M.R., musician-guitarist and director of Bangalore School of Music, who is part of the curating team. "We wanted a platform that would host international artistes and highlight India's own jazz journey."



IN PERFECT SWING Members of the Bosch Big Band

The event will also highlight the city's age-old connection with Germany. "Many artistes of Bengaluru have been collaborating with German musicians for 50 years. Pioneering among them was the late Rama Mani, who recently passed away," he says. "In fact, hundreds of European musicians have shown great interest in Carnatic music, especially the konnakol, and studied at the Karnataka College of Percussion."

Some of the highlights of the show include the Indo-German Jazz Fusion featuring Sukanya Ramgopal; Raghuram Collective featuring Karthik Mani; MoonArra world fusion with Peter Natterer leading up to the finale event featuring the Bosch Big Band. The festival will unfold across interesting venues such as Sabha, the Goethe-Institut and Jagriti Theatre, and also spotlight the city's young and vibrant jazz talents. ■

THE FESTIVAL WILL ALSO HIGHLIGHT THE CITY'S AGE-OLD CONNECTION WITH GERMANY

—Deepa Natarajan Lobo

The Bengaluru Jazz Festival will be held over three weekends from Nov. 8-22. Entry free through RSVP. Visit www.bengalurujazzfest.com